



DuckDuckGo over Google!

Twitter CEO, Jack Dorsey, says he uses DuckDuckGo over Google as his default search engine. <https://dgit.in/dec19-30>



Android 10 coming to S10 series

Samsung started rolling out Android 10 to the Galaxy S10 series along with version 2.0 of One UI, starting in Germany. <https://dgit.in/dec19-31>

Kodak XPro 55 inch 4K smart TV

Decent panel for the price, bleak UI

Budget TVs today offer an interesting feature set, ranging from smart capabilities, Android UI, 4K HDR support and more. But some compromises need to be made to keep a low price point. Here we have a 55-inch TV from Kodak, the 55 4K XPro, priced at ₹28,499. Let's see if it is worth your consideration?

Build and design

The build of the TV is all plastic and isn't very slim. The panel has black bezels around it and they have a glossy finish. The glossy borders can get annoying if you have a well-lit room since they can interfere with the viewing experience. The tabletop stand is metal and holds the TV in place well. The legs aren't too short, giving you enough space to place a soundbar, set-top-box or gaming console below the TV comfortably. Overall, the build is what you'd expect on a budget.

Ports and connectivity

Coming to connectivity, the Kodak XPro has 3 HDMI ports, which are on the side along with ARC support on HDMI 3. You also have the good old antenna port and 2 USB ports. Moving to the back, the TV has the headphones jack, ethernet port, optical audio port, audio out, and 2 AV in ports. The location of the ports on the side makes it easy to reach.

Audio

The TV is pretty loud even at 45 per cent volume. It doesn't crackle until you turn it up quite a bit. It will fill the average-sized living room easily. However, movie and music lack thump. Movie dialogues are audible, but with a background score they sound muffled.

UI and built-in services

The Kodak 55-inch 4K HDR TV runs on Android 7.1.2 (AOSP) out of the box, but it has been modified. Press the home button and you will be greeted with the UI. The App Store gives you access

to almost all the apps available for Android. However, the UI of the TV is its weakest element and we recommend a streaming device to make the most of this TV. Overall, the UI of the TV is something we saw in the past on Kodak TVs and AOSP is not acceptable, especially when other brands provide Android TV experience.

Performance

The display is a 4K panel with support for HDR 10. Despite being HDR enabled, a lot of budget TVs produce images darker than we'd like making it a better experience to watch the content in SDR. That is the same sentiment here. But the panel of the TV is good for a 4K experience only when you connect it to a good source. Overall, you can enjoy 4K content but the HDR performance of the TV is bleak. The picture quality for 1080p content is once again subject to your source. Once you have a good source, you can always jump to the Vivid mode to make the colours punchier, if that's the way you like it. A good thing about the TV is that it gives you access to settings like backlighting, brightness, contrast and more.

When it comes to gaming, our Xbox One X recognized the TV as a 4K TV with HDR. We ran our standard slew of

games. A game like Doom which is in 4K SDR looks good with HDMI 2.0 setting enabled and the TV's HDR toggle on. Change the HDR toggle to off and the colours look washed out. The worst experience was with our 4K HDR benchmark game,

Gears 5. In the dark sequences, the game looked jarringly dark. If 4K HDR gaming is a priority for you, then look elsewhere. But if SDR gaming is what you want, then the TV works fine.

Bottomline

In the 30k budget, there are a good number of options to choose from including Thomson, iFFALLCON, TCL, Xiaomi and more bringing a variety of options in screen sizes, resolution, UI and more. The Kodak TV has a good 4K panel when used with an external source, the audio is acceptable however the UI and HDR performance is lacklustre.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 55-inch Ultra HD 4K | SCREEN RESOLUTION: 3840x2160
| PANEL TYPE: IPS | REFRESH RATE: 60Hz | I/O: 2 USB Ports, 3
HDMI Ports, LAN/Ethernet | ADDITIONAL CONNECTIVITY: WiFi |
PROCESSOR: Quad Core A53 CPU | RAM: 1GB | STORAGE: 8GB |
AUDIO: 24W speakers | OS: Android 7.1.2

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Price
₹28,499



PERFORMANCE.....	54
DESIGN.....	62
FEATURES.....	55
VALUE.....	56